Prologue

Why This Book?

Governments are all about making policies, executing these by formulating legislation and development programmes and providing public goods and services. The government comprises the political executive and civil service. The political executive is primarily responsible for making policies. Economic policymaking is of paramount importance as it plays a critical role in national income, wealth, employment, prosperity, poverty, health of people, health of environment and so much more. The civil service performs three key functions: implementing policies, laws and programmes; delivering public goods and services as well as private goods and services if the government is socialist; and assisting the political executive in making policies.

The other wings of the state—the legislature and the judiciary—also have a significant role in policymaking and implementation. The legislature, the Parliament and legislative assemblies in India, representing the people of India and the states, approve legislations and financial resources to determine and execute policies and programmes. The judiciary keeps a check on both the legislature and the government to ensure they operate according to the basic structure of the Constitution and formulate policies, approve legislations, take up programmes and spend public money within the four walls of the Constitution, the laws of the land and publicly declared policy. The judiciary also administers justice and ensures that the